

Ang Buhay ni José Rizal

This documentary focuses on revealing Rizal's life journey on how he became considered one of the most prominent figures responsible for Filipinos fighting for their civil rights during the Spanish colonial era. This video documentary titled "*And Buhay ng Isang Bayani*" was narrated by Juni Gamboa and featured Pen Medina as José Rizal. It aims to uncover Rizal's humanity and his nature by referring to his private letters, historical photographs, and childhood diary named, *Memorias de un estudiante de Manila*, which he wrote when he was 17 under the pen name "*P. Jacinto*".

Rizal was born on June 19, 1861, in Calamba, Laguna, his mother is Teodora Alonzo, a highly educated woman who is Rizal's first tutor. His father is Francisco Mercado, a hardworking father, he built the family a house on a land owned by the Dominican friars. His early childhood depicts him as someone who has every potential to become anyone he wanted to be. He loved painting animals, birds, plants, he loved listening to his nanny's songs and tales. Even as a child his genuine passion to appreciate art and skills is something that isn't just born with him, he molded it as he grew reflecting his natural talent to create his influential literary pieces. Rizal first started schooling in Biñan under *Maestro Justiniano Cruz* with the help of his older brother *Paciano*. Despite his intelligence he faced a harsh environment where physical discipline was a daily occurrence. This point in Rizal's life may have started his personal desire to fight for what is right. In an unfortunate event, his mother was wrongfully imprisoned for being falsely accused of poisoning her sister-in-law. She was imprisoned for nearly two and a half years leaving the young Rizal deeply traumatized and untrusting of friendships. This would not only solidify his deep resentment for an unjust and corrupted system but also his commitment to a more civilized society.

José Rizal is a deeply passionate individual. His genuine talent for art and his intelligence showed his development to becoming one of the greatest writers in Philippine history. His harsh childhood depicts the motivation he accumulated to fight for his beliefs and the civic duty to fight for what is right. The wrongful imprisonment of his mother resulted in his deeply untrusting nature in his childhood, as he grew up, this developed into his opposition to the cancerous and unjustful nature of Spanish societal orders, mainly caused by Spanish religious friars which he himself believes to be his main enemy in his adulthood.